

Free / Open-Source TTS Operators

— Kannada, Hindi, English

HR26-AI-02 (Marketing Campaigns). Svava-TTS details were checked on its Hugging Face pages. Everything else is from memory, so confirm license and language support on each model card.

Operators and links

Operator	License	Link
Svara-TTS v1	Apache 2.0	https://huggingface.co/kenpath/svara-tts-v1 (https://huggingface.co/kenpath/svara-tts-v1)
Svara-TTS inference repo	Apache 2.0	https://github.com/Kenpath/svara-tts-inference (https://github.com/Kenpath/svara-tts-inference)
Svara-TTS demo	n/a	https://huggingface.co/spaces/kenpath/svara-tts (https://huggingface.co/spaces/kenpath/svara-tts)
Svara Indic text normalizer	check repo	https://github.com/Kenpath/indic-text-normalization (https://github.com/Kenpath/indic-text-normalization)
Svara-TTS FP8 (community build, low VRAM)	Apache 2.0	https://huggingface.co/srikantp/svara-tts-v1-fp8 (https://huggingface.co/srikantp/svara-tts-v1-fp8)
Svara-TTS voice-clone beta	check card	https://huggingface.co/kenpath/svara-tts-voiceclone-beta (https://huggingface.co/kenpath/svara-tts-voiceclone-beta)
Indic Parler-TTS (AI4Bharat)	Apache 2.0	https://huggingface.co/ai4bharat/indic-parler-tts (https://huggingface.co/ai4bharat/indic-parler-tts)
IndicF5 (AI4Bharat)	MIT	https://huggingface.co/ai4bharat/IndicF5 (https://huggingface.co/ai4bharat/IndicF5)
Indic-TTS (AI4Bharat)	MIT	https://github.com/AI4Bharat/Indic-TTS (https://github.com/AI4Bharat/Indic-TTS)
MMS-TTS Kannada (Meta)	CC-BY-NC	https://huggingface.co/facebook/mms-tts-kan (https://huggingface.co/facebook/mms-tts-kan)
MMS-TTS Hindi (Meta)	CC-BY-NC	https://huggingface.co/facebook/mms-tts-hin (https://huggingface.co/facebook/mms-tts-hin)
MMS-TTS English (Meta)	CC-BY-NC	https://huggingface.co/facebook/mms-tts-eng (https://huggingface.co/facebook/mms-tts-eng)
Piper	MIT	https://github.com/rhasspy/piper (https://github.com/rhasspy/piper)
Piper voices	per voice	https://huggingface.co/rhasspy/piper-voices (https://huggingface.co/rhasspy/piper-voices)
Kokoro-82M	Apache 2.0	https://huggingface.co/hexgrad/Kokoro-82M (https://huggingface.co/hexgrad/Kokoro-82M)
XTTS-v2 (Coqui)	CPML (non-commercial)	https://huggingface.co/coqui/XTTS-v2 (https://huggingface.co/coqui/XTTS-v2)

Comparison for our problem statement

Our needs: Kannada + Hindi + English (code-mixed Kanglish/Hinglish), natural-sounding for a café owner's campaign voice read-back, usable on hackathon hardware.

Operator	Kannada	Hindi	English	Code-mix (Kanglish/Hinglish)	Naturalness	Hardware	Commercial use	Fit
Svara-TTS v1	Yes	Yes	Indian English	Shared multilingual model, most promising	High	GPU (FP8 build: ~6–8 GB VRAM)	Yes	Best overall

Operator	Kannada	Hindi	English	Code-mix (Kanglish/Hinglish)	Naturalness	Hardware	Commercial use	Fit
Indic Parler-TTS	Yes	Yes	Yes	Good in native script (verify)	High	GPU preferred	Yes	Best alternative
IndicF5	Yes	Yes	Unsure	Voice cloning from reference clip	High	GPU	Yes	Good if cloning is needed
Indic-TTS (AI4Bharat)	Yes	Yes	Indian English	No (per-language models)	Medium	CPU OK	Yes	Best CPU-only option
Piper	Unclear	Yes	Excellent	No	Medium	CPU, real-time	Yes	English/Hindi fallback
Kokoro-82M	No	Yes	Very good	Limited	Medium-high	CPU, fast	Yes	English fallback only
MMS-TTS	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Low (robotic)	CPU, fast	No (NC)	Last resort
XTTS-v2	No	Yes	Yes	Shaky	High	GPU preferred	No (NC)	Skip for this problem

Verdict

1. **Svara-TTS v1** is the best fit. One model covers Kannada, Hindi and Indian English, it is Apache 2.0, and it ships a text normalizer.
2. **Indic Parler-TTS** is the best alternative and the one to compare against Svara.
3. **Indic-TTS (AI4Bharat)** is the pick if you have no GPU.
4. **Piper / Kokoro** cover English and Hindi on CPU.
5. **MMS-TTS** is a last resort because of its robotic voice and non-commercial license.

